

Philosophy

#7: Freewill & Determinism

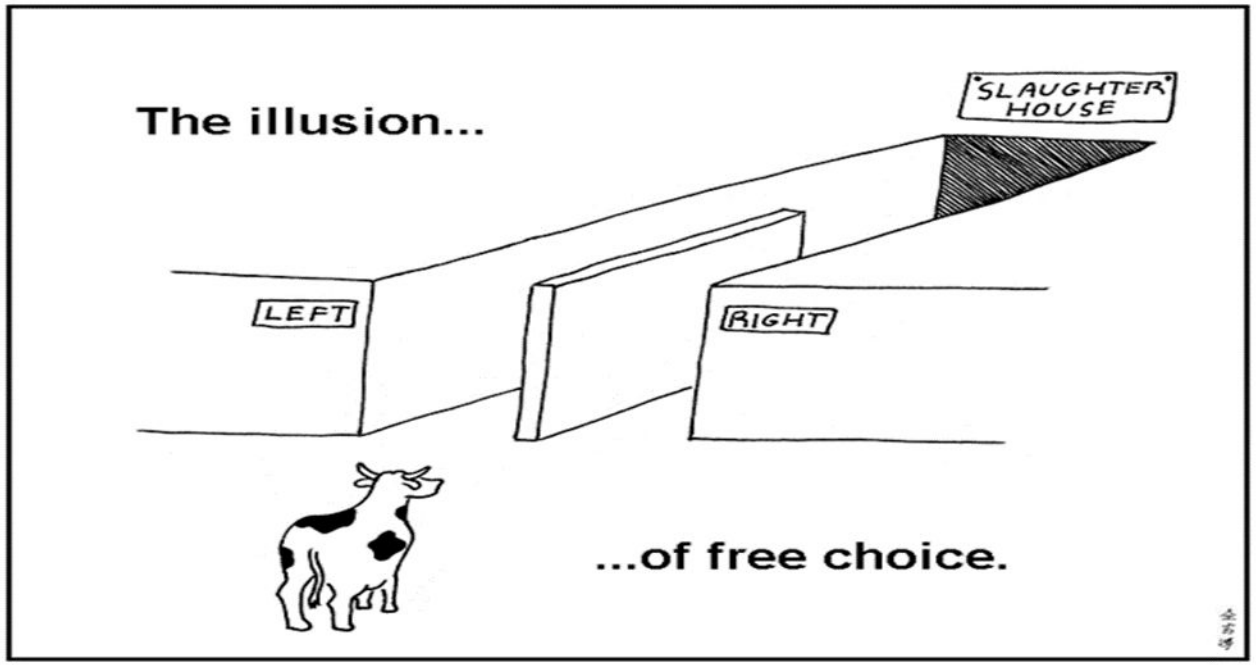
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Critical questions

- Are we free or determined?
- How do we determined ?
- Do we have moral responsibility?



Determinism

ALL ACTIONS OR EVENT ARE PREDETERMINED.

Determinism

- "Determinist believes that every event, including every human action, is governed by natural laws. Every event has cause of universal law that govern the whole world."
- The theory that every event, including every human action, is governed by natural laws. Every event has cause of universal law that govern the whole world.
- Our actions are beyond our control; all events are predetermined.
- Baron Holbach said that the brain is material; its actions (e.g., thought, will) are dictated by physical laws, heredity, and environment.

TYPES of Determinism

1. **Causal (scientific) Determinism**
   - Every event is caused by a preceding event following the laws of physics.
   - Rooted in Newtonian mechanics.

2. **Religious Determinism**
   - God determines all that happens (divine foreknowledge or predestination).

3. **Psychological Determinism**
   - Human behavior is determined by internal mental states, desires, and experiences.

4. **Biological/Genetic Determinism**
   - Actions are determined by biology or genetics.

Thought Experiment

What do you think ?

1. Neuroscientific challenge
2. The rolling ball
3. The locked room
4. A random flip coin

Who controls your life?
We are The puppet





ArenaPal/Topham/The Image Works

Theories Explaining Human Behavior

Human Nature

People are born with certain basic instincts that influence how they behave.

Environmental Influences

People are shaped by their environment, conditioned by their experiences to be the kind of people they are.

Psychological Forces

People are governed by psychological forces, some of them unconscious, that cause them to think, feel, and act in certain ways.

Social Dynamics

People are social creatures who are influenced by the social forces around them.

Free Will

People make free choices that reflect and shape who they are, and they are responsible for the consequences of these choices.

1. Determinism: Fatalism



- There is nothing that we can do to affect our lives in any significant way.
- For example, I cannot in any way affect whether I am going to have a fatal accident tomorrow.
- Fatalism often takes the form of RELIGIOUS PREDESTINATION

Fatalism

- The idea of fatalism coincides with destiny. This means that everything in our lives is predestined by fate. In other words, everything we have done, are doing now, and will do, cannot and will not be changed in any way. Our feeling of being free is an illusion.

2. Religious determinism

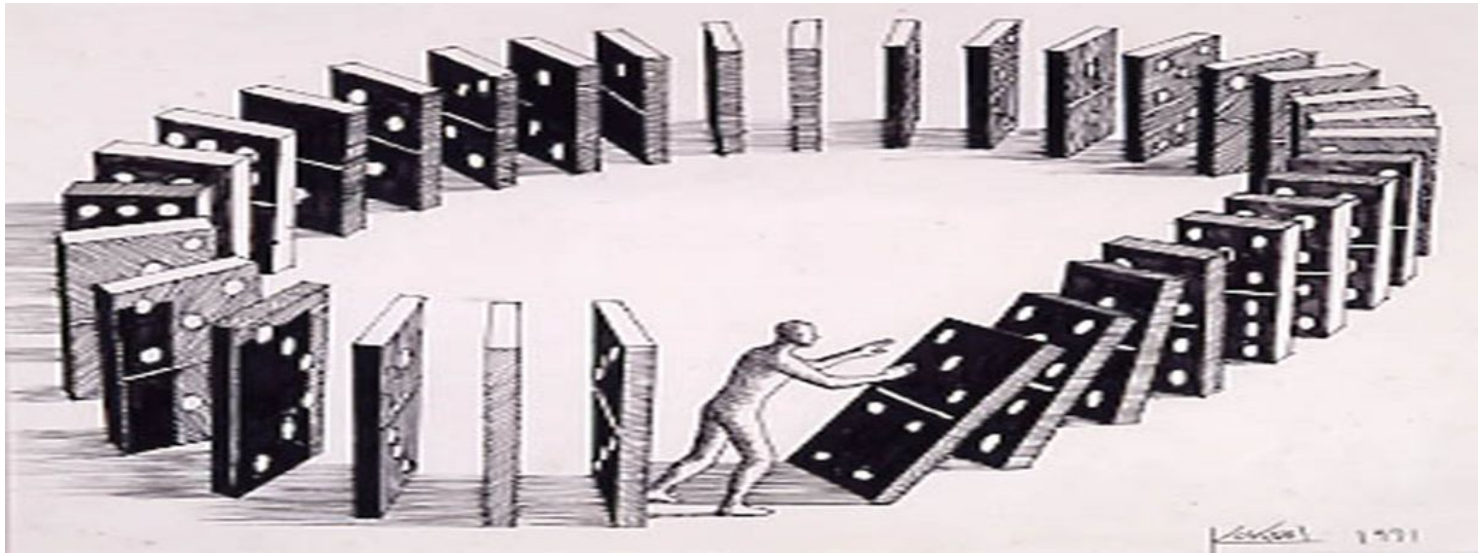




3.Scientific /Causal Determinism:

All events (including human actions) have specific causes

Baron d'Holbach(1723-89) said that the brain is material; its actions (e.g., thought, will) are dictated by physical laws, heredity, and environment



Hard determinism:

- All choices are determined by other events or actions prior to the choice. They are caused by other events/actions.
- Concept of free will is an illusion
- We make decisions believing that we do so as we have free will when actually this apparent choice was already determined to be made
- If everything is determined we are not free at all and we can therefore not be held accountable for our own actions as we didn't choose to do so or commit those actions

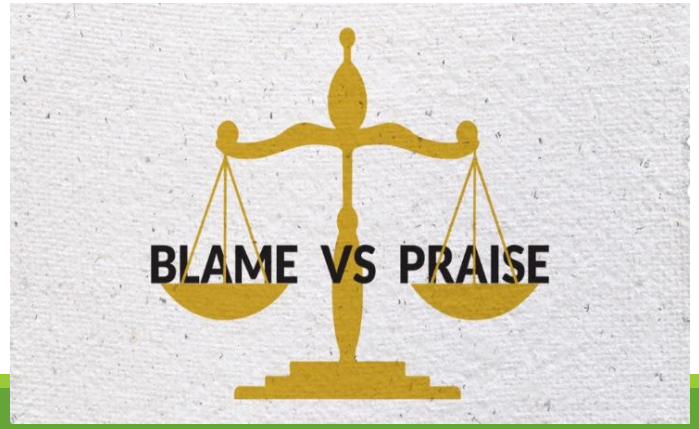
WHAT IF
determinism is true it would seem that:

I. We are no more free than robots.



II. There is no reason to praise or blame anyone. It is wrong to punish criminals--because they "can't help it".

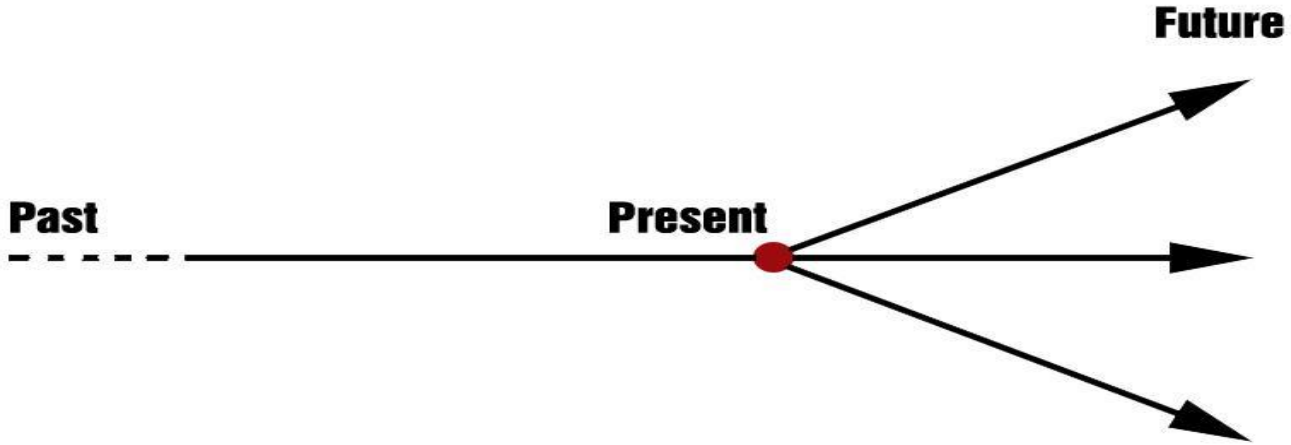
III. Do praise, blame or punishment make sense without moral responsibility?





Moral responsibility is compatible with Freewill

Society generally holds people responsible for their actions, and will say that they deserve praise or blame for what they do.



FREE WILL/LIBERTARIANISM

HUMAN ACTIONS ARE FREE

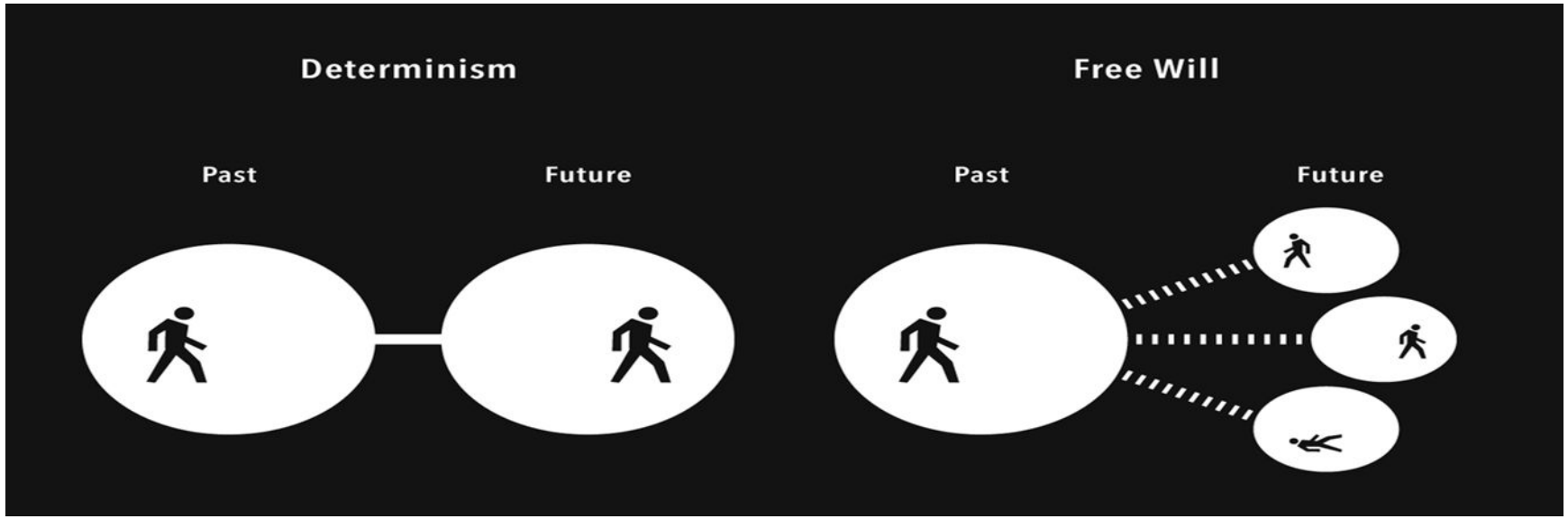
Freewill Position

- People are absolutely responsible for what they do.Our actions are not determined. Our actions are not caused by previous events in accordance with universal law.
- Libertarianism is the view that humans have free will , and that we have the freedom to choose what we want, and that our choices are not predetermined.

FREE WILL/Indeterminism

Libertarianism:

- This suggests that we are completely free and not determined in any way shape or form.
- People had rejected determinism as it rules out any responsibility that individuals have
- Also known as incompatabilism due to it being incompatable with determinism
- They believe that cause and effect isn't relevant
- There is no compulsion to act, so every choice is very free and this makes us responsible for performing or committing these free acts
- As we chose the cause of action we must also take responsibility for it whatever the consequence as we chose to do it.
- Libertarianism: this theory claims that we are morally responsible for all our actions and are free to make choices



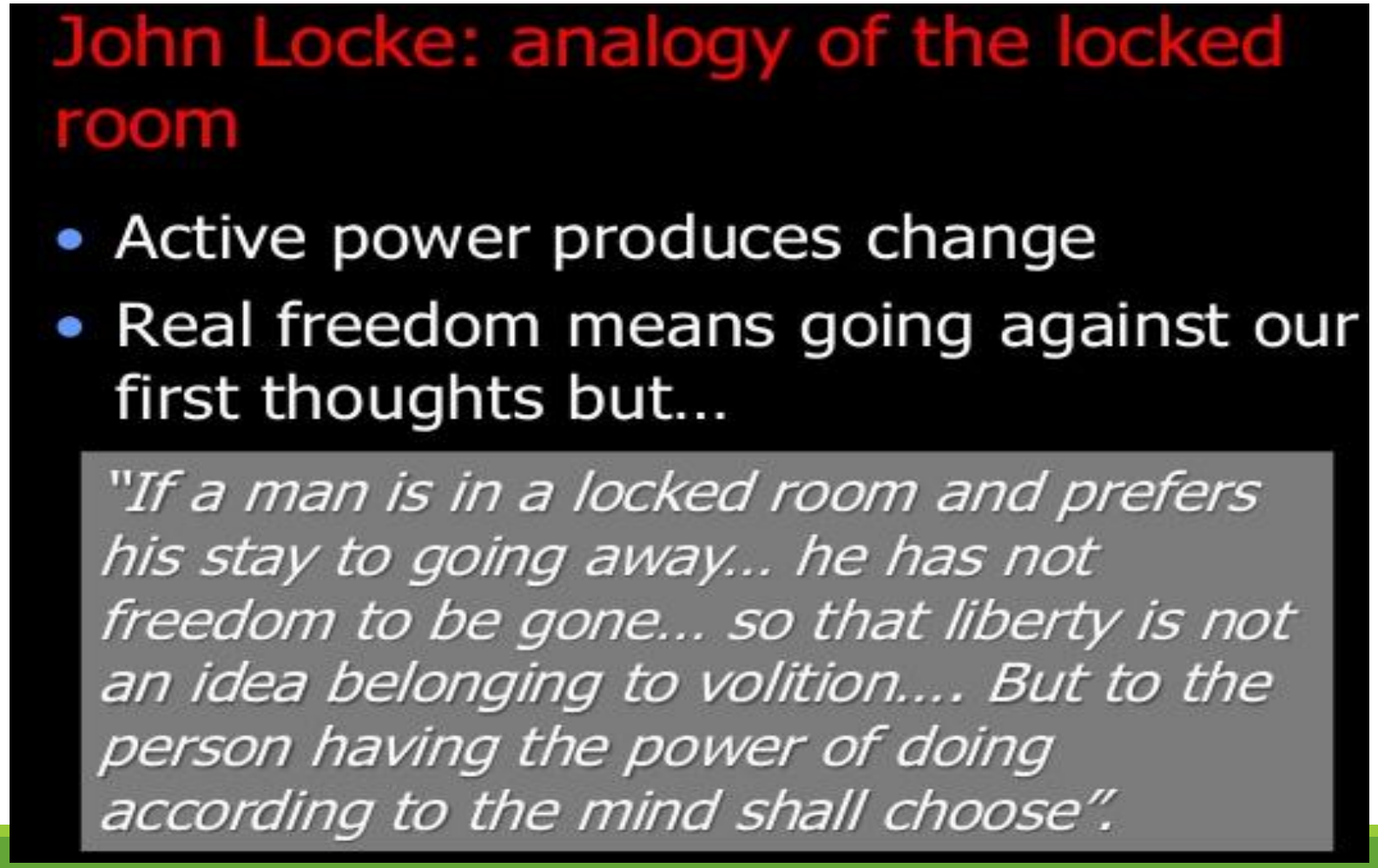
COMPATIBILISM

BOTH FREEWILL AND DETERMINISM IS TRUE

FREEDOM IS POSSIBLE ALL ACTIONS ARE DEPENDENT

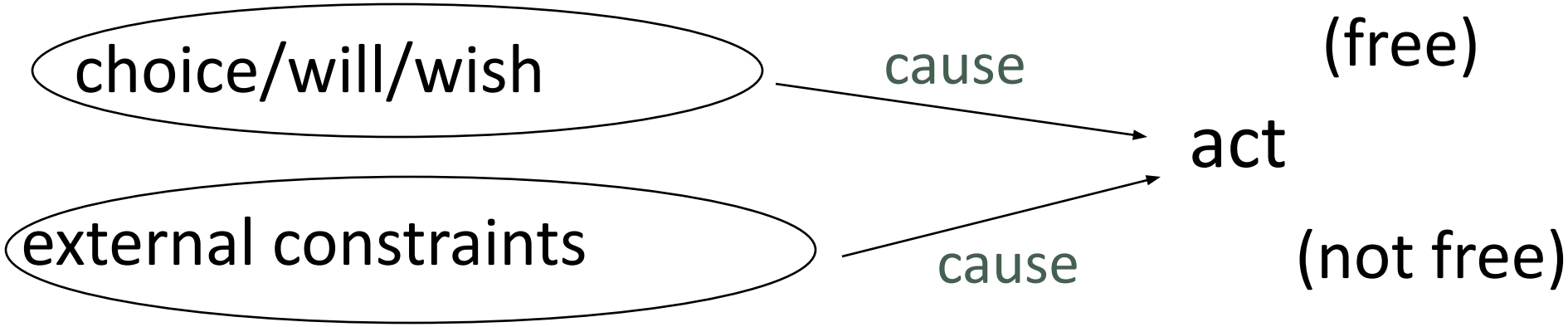
Soft determinist Position

Compatibilist maintain that determinism is compatible with free will. Some act are caused by individual personal history and motivation.



Compatibilism: HUME
Freedom is compatible with determinism

A “free” act is simply one that is caused (i.e., preceded) by our choice or act of will. We are free when we can do what we want.



Objection: aren’t *choices* caused by “external” forces (e.g., genetics, culture, upbringing)?

Compatibilism - Soft determinism

Compatibilists maintain that determinism is compatible with free will.

A “free” act is simply one that is caused (i.e., preceded) by our choice or act of will. We are free when we can do what we want.

Some act are caused by individual personal history and motivation.

Soft determinism

- It seeks to bring freedom and accountability together with the sense that choices are predetermined by prior choices
- They believe that free will and determinism are compatible with each other, hence why this theory is called compatablism
- It suggests that our values, desires and prior choices can determine how we will act in certain situations.

Hard and *Soft* Determinism

"Old-fashioned determinism was what we may call hard determinism. It did not shrink from such words as fatality, bondage of the will, necessitation, and the like. Nowadays, we have a soft determinism which abhors harsh words, and, repudiating fatality, necessity, and even predetermination, says that its real name is freedom; for freedom is only necessity understood, and bondage to the highest is identical with true freedom."

("The Dilemma of Determinism," *The Will to Believe* (New York, Dover, 1956), p. 149.)

Today, Soft Determinism is called *Compatibilism*

Difference between

FREEWILL

We have ability to choose ,act and think freely.

Human have write their own destiny and fate.

Human actions are not determined by external conditions.

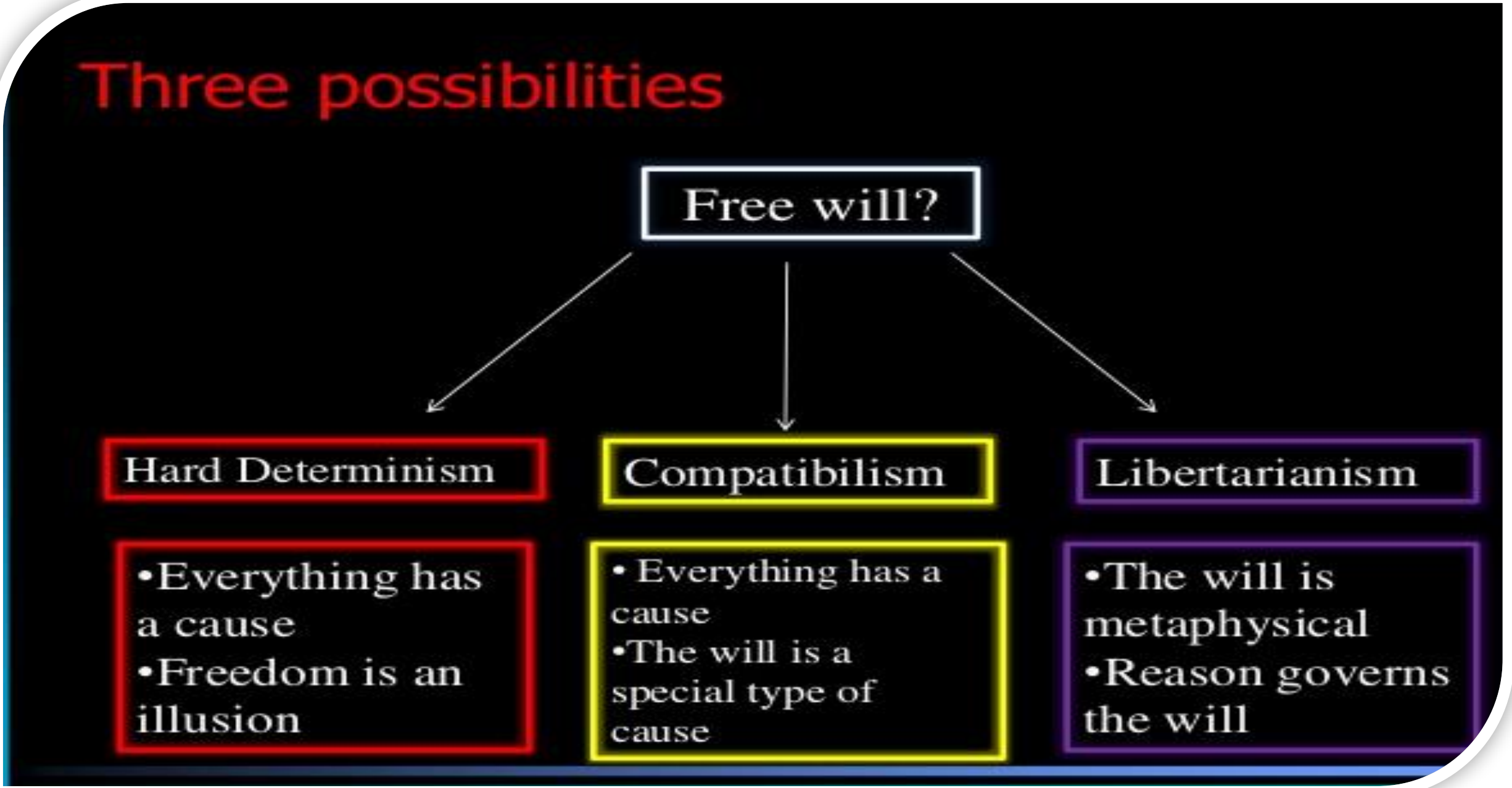
DETERMINISM

Human actions are controlled by prior events in law of nature or motion.

All events are caused by other events.

There is no freewill or freedom is an illusion.

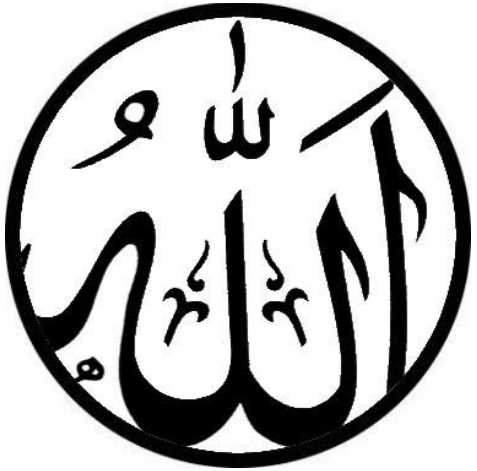
Three possibilities



In Islamic Philosophy

Free will, according to Islamic doctrine is the main factor for man's accountability in his/her actions throughout life.

All actions taken by man's free will are said to be counted on the Day of Judgement because they are his/her own and not God's.



Thinking Philosophically

What Are Your Assumptions About Freedom?

Think critically about your own assumptions regarding personal freedom by responding to the following questions:

- How would you explain the actions discussed earlier? Do you believe that people's decisions are determined by factors such as human instincts, their environment, their psychological makeup, or social dynamics? Do you think this is always the case?
- Do you believe that you can improve yourself by establishing goals and making intelligent choices to achieve those goals? If so, do you believe that you are personally responsible for both the positive and "less positive" aspects of yourself? Why or why not?
- Do you accept full responsibility for all of the moral choices you have made, even those you may regret having made? Why or why not?

Thinking Philosophically

What Are The Limitations to Your Freedom?

Making full use of your freedom involves first identifying the constraints that limit your freedom. Use this thinking activity to begin this self-reflective process, which will prepare you for increasing your freedom.

- Identify some of the important *external constraints* or limitations on your options that are imposed by people or circumstances outside of you. Are there people in your life who actively seek to limit your freedom? Are you locked into situations that present limited opportunities?
- Identify some of the important *internal constraints* in your life. Which behaviors feel out of your conscious control and have a negative effect on your life, undermining many of the positive goals that you are striving for? If you are asked "why" you are making the choice, are you able to provide a persuasive, rational explanation? Or are you at a loss to explain why you are behaving this way, other than to say, "I can't help myself"?

3 POSITIONS ON DETERMINISM:

1. Human beings do NOT have free will (‘hard determinism’)

2. Human beings have free will (‘libertarianism’).

3. Both determinist and libertarian is TRUE, human beings DO have free will and determined some nature.(‘soft determinism’).

Views of Free Will

Hard Determinism	1. All events and human actions are brought about by previous events in accordance with universal causal laws. 2. Human freedom is an illusion.
Compatibilism	1. All events and human actions are brought about by previous events in accordance with universal causal laws. 2. Human actions are free if they are the result of internal motivations, not the product of external influences or constraints.
Indeterminism and Libertarianism	1. At least some human actions are not determined by previous events in accordance with universal causal laws. 2. *Indeterminist*: Human freedom is possible because some actions may be random. 3. *Libertarian*: Human freedom is possible because people are able to make genuinely free choices by exercising their free will.

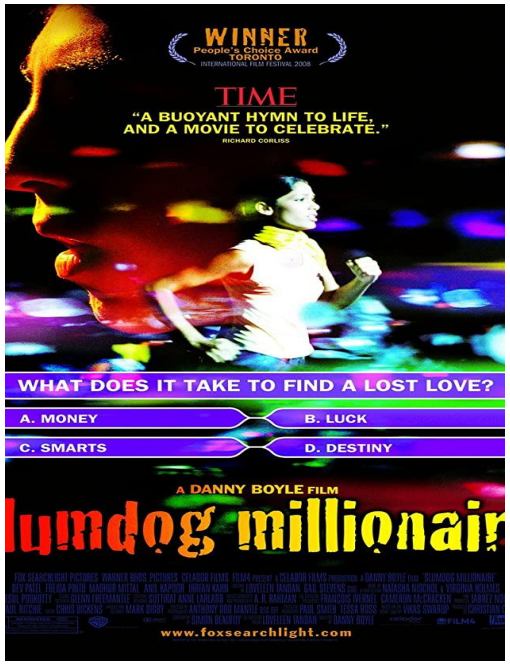
Conclusion

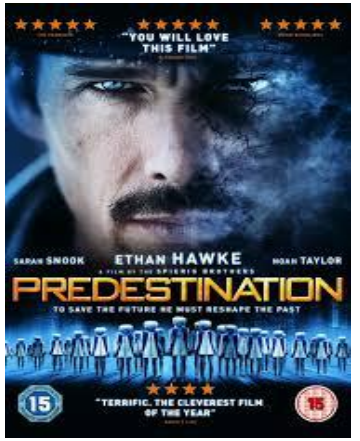
Three Views of The Will

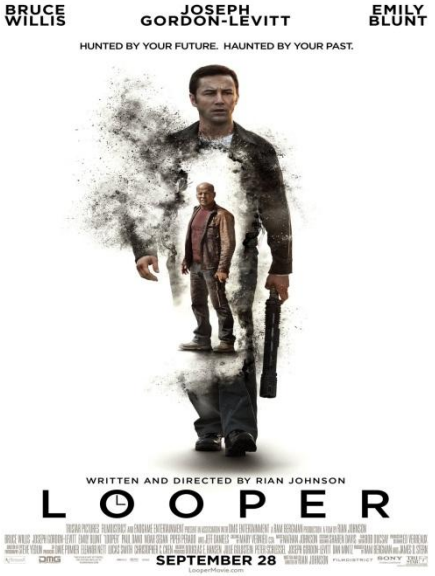
- ***Libertarianism*** – the agent has more than one option open to her and could have chosen otherwise than she actually chose. The libertarian believes that the movement of the will is *uncaused* but also *not* random. Choices are solely and fundamentally the agent's own choices. An agent's choice of what they want is not a necessary one, and the responsibility for her choice lies solely with her.
- ***Compatibilism*** - the agent only has one option open to her, but she still chooses the action that she wants to choose. The compabilist believes that the movement of the will is caused by factors external to it (such as one's character, values, environment, etc.). An agent's choice of what they want is determined by her desire (external to the will) but is also free because she does what she wants. Because of the latter, agents are responsible.
- ***Determinism*** – the agent has only one option open to her; thus, she is not free because freedom requires the ability to choose otherwise than she actually chose. The determinist believes that the movement of the will is influenced by external factors of biology, genetics, etc. Every event has some cause or other, so an agent's choice is thus determined by some antecedent event or other. An agent's choice is a necessary one. Many determinists deny moral responsibility.

Movie review









5-Freewill and Determinism

